opposition party, put relentless pressure on the Zardari government until it was forced to yield on 9 March 2009, agreeing to reinstate the deposed judges.

However, while students had been politically very active during the lawyers' movement, the political engagement quickly died down after the 2008 elections, despite the media hype around the rise of PTI and their leader's popularity among young people.

Politics beyond the lawyers' movement and the hype of the youth vote in the 2013 Elections

The hype around the 'youth vote' started with PTI's direct engagement with the youth after 2009. The main argument had been that in the 2013 elections a new generation of young Pakistani voters would emerge that had never been to the polls before and that they wanted change. Imran Khan was already popular among Pakistanis, a national hero for having led the Pakistan cricket team to victory in the 1992 World Cup. He was also a well-known philanthropist. He was therefore the ideal leader to attract especially young Pakistanis to politics. PTI's agenda was simple, to combat corruption, which was perceived to be the main reason for Pakistan's domestic and international failures. The strategy for combating corruption, though, lacked focus, with PTI often undermining the fundamentals of democracy and the Parliament in its quest to defeat corruption. Imran Khan's[9] PTI targeted youth participation by 'aiding them in their procurement of the party's membership' (Express Tribune 2012). The Insaf Student Federation (ISF) was set up as the official student wing of PTI with youth representatives from all five provinces.[10] Forums were set up on social networking sites such as Facebook and Twitter in order to encourage youth to use social media to participate and express their views. They raised debates on issues such as 'Rental Power Plants, the shortcomings in the education system and the environmental and medical hazards in the country'[11] at the Youth Parliament. In the autumn of 2011, a rally in Lahore attracted 100,000 supporters, most of them young. This turnout, in the stronghold of Pakistan's chief opposition party the PML(N), stunned politicians and analysts alike. The PTI's next rally in Karachi attracted a similar number of supporters. Since then the PTI has been credited with re-engaging the youth in politics, and much of the media hype before and around the elections focused on the youth vote, and what role social media played in this re-engagement process.[12] However,